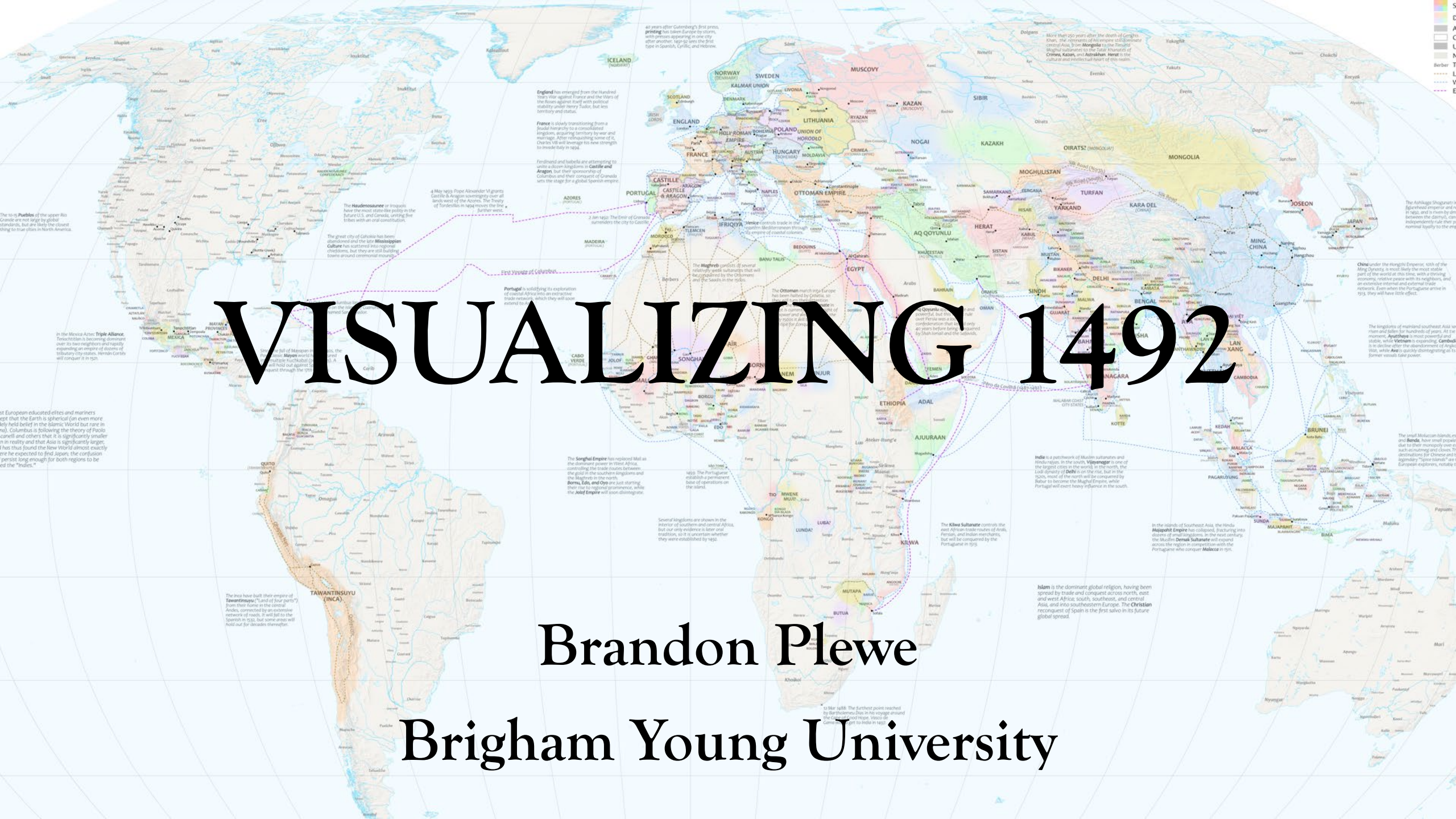


VISUALIZING 1492

Brandon Plewe

Brigham Young University

WHY 1492?

- The eve of European hegemony
- The world on its own terms
- 700+ states!
- I like "it's complicated"



THE STATE IN 1492

- Montevideo 1933, but...
- State-ness
- Sovereign-ness
- Territory-ness
- Knowledge-ness



BUT DO WE CARE?

- Audience, purpose, scale
- "ish" is enough
  - Fuzzy sets
  - MacEachren CP 1992
  - ~~Plewe 2003~~
- Something a historian could actually do
- Reproducible, automatable

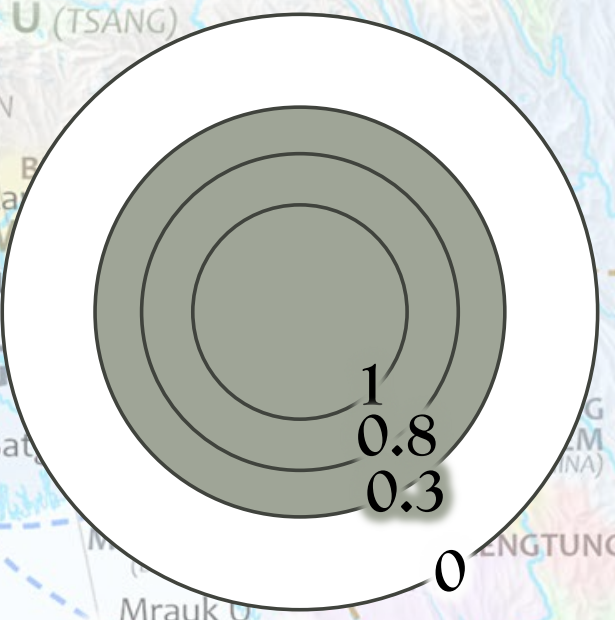


THE DATA

- State polygons
  - Levels of sovereignty: sovereign states, dependent states, supra-states
  - Uncertain existence flag
- Boundary lines
  - Disaggregated by certainty
  - Transition zone width (order-ish of magnitude)
  - 1=200-500m . . . 4 = 5-12km . . . 8 = 200-500km

PROCESSING . . .

1. Buffer boundaries at min + max widths
2. Add to, subtract from polygons
   - Iso-sovs(???) with membership
   - Dependent states lower
3. TIN
4. Raster of membership field for each color
5. 6+1 colors, fuzzy edges, interblended



COMPOSITING

- Transparency ramp
- Uncertain existence hatched
- Cities, non-state societies, trade routes
- Static fine
- Interactive?



THANK YOU!

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- github.com/bplewe/1492

